

CEO

Cameron Ellis

CEO · ACADEMIC

HIRE

◆ 5

SIGNATURE

Signature: one copy per deck.

Commit: Play a card by paying Surplus instead of Leverage, at its normal timing.

Created the game.

Hentges Fellow of Finance and Associate Professor at the University of Iowa. Fellow of the Vaughan Institute of Risk Management.

cellis212.github.io

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 166 / 357

Des Moines

OFFICE LOCATION

OPEN

◆ 3 branch only

Headquarters or Open as a branch.

At the start of your turn, gain 1 Surplus for every 4 Life or Annuity funding sources you control, rounded down.

At the start of your turn, if you control a Life or Annuity funding source and a Private Credit Fund, gain 1 Surplus (once, regardless of copies).

Long lives, long loans, and a very short commute.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 338 / 357

Group Life

LIFE

CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

CARRYING COST

● 1 each turn

▲ Mortality ▼ Longevity

Your maximum hand size is 1 higher.

Life insurance the employer buys for everyone, and nobody remembers signing up for.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 002 / 357

FUNDING SOURCE

Group Life

LIFE

CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

CARRYING COST

● 1 each turn

▲ Mortality ▼ Longevity

Your maximum hand size is 1 higher.

Life insurance the employer buys for everyone, and nobody remembers signing up for.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 002 / 357

FUNDING SOURCE

Group Life

LIFE

CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

CARRYING COST

● 1 each turn

▲ Mortality ▼ Longevity

Your maximum hand size is 1 higher.

Life insurance the employer buys for everyone, and nobody remembers signing up for.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 002 / 357

Term Life

LIFE

CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN

● 1 run start

STAPLE

▲ Mortality ▲ Low Interest Rates ▼ Longevity

Staple: any number per deck.

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

Coverage for a set term that most customers outlive, which is the business model.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 003 / 357

FUNDING SOURCE

Term Life

LIFE

CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN

● 1 run start

STAPLE

▲ Mortality ▲ Low Interest Rates ▼ Longevity

Staple: any number per deck.

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

Coverage for a set term that most customers outlive, which is the business model.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 003 / 357

FUNDING SOURCE

Term Life

LIFE

CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN

● 1 run start

STAPLE

▲ Mortality ▲ Low Interest Rates ▼ Longevity

Staple: any number per deck.

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

Coverage for a set term that most customers outlive, which is the business model.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 003 / 357

FUNDING SOURCE

Term Life

LIFE

CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN

● 1 run start

STAPLE

▲ Mortality ▲ Low Interest Rates ▼ Longevity

Staple: any number per deck.

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

Coverage for a set term that most customers outlive, which is the business model.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 003 / 357

Whole Life

LIFE

STAPLE FUNDING SOURCE

CAPACITY

1

Leverage a turn

MARGIN

1

run start

STAPLE

▲ Mortality

▲ Low Interest Rates

▼ Longevity

▼ Inflation

Staple: any number per deck.

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

Lifelong coverage plus a savings account, plus a sales pitch for both.

L

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 001 / 357

Whole Life

LIFE

STAPLE FUNDING SOURCE

CAPACITY

1

Leverage a turn

MARGIN

1

run start

STAPLE

▲ Mortality

▲ Low Interest Rates

▼ Longevity

▼ Inflation

Staple: any number per deck.

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

Lifelong coverage plus a savings account, plus a sales pitch for both.

L

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 001 / 357

Index-Linked Annuity

ANNUITY

FUNDING SOURCE

CAPACITY

1

Leverage a turn

CARRYING COST

1

each turn

▲ Short-Term Equity

▼ Long-Term Equity

Your maximum hand size is 1 higher.

Stock-market upside with a ceiling, downside with a floor, and an actuary in between.

A

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 008 / 357

Index-Linked Annuity

ANNUITY

FUNDING SOURCE

CAPACITY

1

Leverage a turn

CARRYING COST

1

each turn

▲ Short-Term Equity

▼ Long-Term Equity

Your maximum hand size is 1 higher.

Stock-market upside with a ceiling, downside with a floor, and an actuary in between.

A

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 008 / 357

Index-Linked Annuity

ANNUITY

FUNDING SOURCE

CAPACITY

1

Leverage a turn

CARRYING COST

1

each turn

▲ Short-Term Equity

▼ Long-Term Equity

Your maximum hand size is 1 higher.

Stock-market upside with a ceiling, downside with a floor, and an actuary in between.

A

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 008 / 357

Fixed Annuity

ANNUITY

STAPLE FUNDING SOURCE

CAPACITY

1

Leverage a turn

MARGIN

1

run start

STAPLE

▲ Longevity

▲ Low Interest Rates

▼ Mortality

Staple: any number per deck.

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

Guaranteed checks for the customer; interest-rate nightmares for you.

A

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 010 / 357

Fixed Annuity

ANNUITY

STAPLE FUNDING SOURCE

CAPACITY

1

Leverage a turn

MARGIN

1

run start

STAPLE

▲ Longevity

▲ Low Interest Rates

▼ Mortality

Staple: any number per deck.

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

Guaranteed checks for the customer; interest-rate nightmares for you.

A

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 010 / 357

Fixed Annuity

ANNUITY

STAPLE FUNDING SOURCE

CAPACITY

1

Leverage a turn

MARGIN

1

run start

STAPLE

▲ Longevity

▲ Low Interest Rates

▼ Mortality

Staple: any number per deck.

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

Guaranteed checks for the customer; interest-rate nightmares for you.

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ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 010 / 357

Fixed Annuity

ANNUITY

STAPLE FUNDING SOURCE

CAPACITY

1

Leverage a turn

MARGIN

1

run start

STAPLE

▲ Longevity

▲ Low Interest Rates

▼ Mortality

Staple: any number per deck.

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

Guaranteed checks for the customer; interest-rate nightmares for you.

A

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 010 / 357

INVESTMENT

Corn Farms

INVESTMENT



COST	YIELD	SALE
◆ 2	● 1 each turn	1 any time

▲ Volatility
▼ Inflation

Yield +1 while you have an office in Des Moines.

Destroyed if a Nat Cat Stress Test hits you.

Planted in April, priced in Chicago, and paid for by the weather.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 104 / 357

INVESTMENT

Corn Farms

INVESTMENT



COST	YIELD	SALE
◆ 2	● 1 each turn	1 any time

▲ Volatility
▼ Inflation

Yield +1 while you have an office in Des Moines.

Destroyed if a Nat Cat Stress Test hits you.

Planted in April, priced in Chicago, and paid for by the weather.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 104 / 357

INVESTMENT

Soy Farms

INVESTMENT



COST	YIELD	SALE
◆ 2	● 1 each turn	1 any time

▲ Volatility
▼ Inflation

Crop rotation. Yield +1 while this is paired with a Corn Farms you control, one to one.

Destroyed if a Nat Cat Stress Test hits you.

Corn one year and soybeans the next, because the nitrogen comes free even if the price doesn't.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 105 / 357

INVESTMENT

Soy Farms

INVESTMENT



COST	YIELD	SALE
◆ 2	● 1 each turn	1 any time

▲ Volatility
▼ Inflation

Crop rotation. Yield +1 while this is paired with a Corn Farms you control, one to one.

Destroyed if a Nat Cat Stress Test hits you.

Corn one year and soybeans the next, because the nitrogen comes free even if the price doesn't.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 105 / 357

INVESTMENT

Private Credit Fund

ILLIQUID



COST	YIELD
◆ 5	● 3 each turn

ILLIQUID
▲ Short-Term Equity
▼ Inflation

Illiquid: can't be liquidated.

Destroyed if Liquidity Crunch, Bank Run, or Global Recession hits you.

Marked to model, quarterly.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 071 / 357

INVESTMENT

Private Credit Fund

ILLIQUID



COST	YIELD
◆ 5	● 3 each turn

ILLIQUID
▲ Short-Term Equity
▼ Inflation

Illiquid: can't be liquidated.

Destroyed if Liquidity Crunch, Bank Run, or Global Recession hits you.

Marked to model, quarterly.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 071 / 357

INVESTMENT

Private Equity

ILLIQUID



COST
◆ 3

ILLIQUID
▲ Regulation

Illiquid: can't be liquidated.

Your maximum hand size is 1 higher.

Destroyed if a Liquidity Stress Test hits you.

No distributions yet, which the fund calls the J-curve.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 052 / 357

INVESTMENT

Private Equity

ILLIQUID



COST
◆ 3

ILLIQUID
▲ Regulation

Illiquid: can't be liquidated.

Your maximum hand size is 1 higher.

Destroyed if a Liquidity Stress Test hits you.

No distributions yet, which the fund calls the J-curve.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 052 / 357

PROGRAM

Risk Committee Veto

RESPONSE



COST
◆ 3

RESPONSE

Response: play while a Stress Test is being run.

Stop a Stress Test that hits you. The runner cannot pay to push it through. This cannot Stop an Act of God.

The minutes will reflect that we said no.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 162 / 357

PROGRAM

Risk Committee Veto

RESPONSE

COST
♦ 3

RESPONSE

Response: play while a Stress Test is being run.

Stop a Stress Test that hits you. The runner cannot pay to push it through. This cannot Stop an Act of God.

The minutes will reflect that we said no.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 162 / 357

PROGRAM

Risk Committee Veto

RESPONSE

COST
♦ 3

RESPONSE

Response: play while a Stress Test is being run.

Stop a Stress Test that hits you. The runner cannot pay to push it through. This cannot Stop an Act of God.

The minutes will reflect that we said no.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 162 / 357

PROGRAM

Crisis Communications

RESPONSE

COST
♦ 1

RESPONSE

Response: play while a Stress Test is being run.

Stop a Reputation Stress Test that hits you, unless the player who ran it pays 2 more Leverage.

"We take this matter extremely seriously," said the statement drafted in advance.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 126 / 357

PROGRAM

Crisis Communications

RESPONSE

COST
♦ 1

RESPONSE

Response: play while a Stress Test is being run.

Stop a Reputation Stress Test that hits you, unless the player who ran it pays 2 more Leverage.

"We take this matter extremely seriously," said the statement drafted in advance.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 126 / 357

SIGNATURE PROGRAM

Industry Lobbying

RESPONSE

COST
♦ 2

SIGNATURE

RESPONSE

Signature: one copy per deck; Response: play while a Stress Test is being run.

Stop a Regulation Stress Test that hits you, unless the player who ran it pays 3 more Leverage.

The trade association would like to submit four hundred pages of comments.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 125 / 357

PROGRAM

Incident Response Retainer

RESPONSE

COST
♦ 1

RESPONSE

Response: play while a Stress Test is being run.

Stop a Cyber Stress Test that hits you, unless the player who ran it pays 2 more Leverage.

The forensics team is on a plane before the ransom note finishes loading.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 127 / 357

SIGNATURE PROGRAM

Everything Is Fine

RESPONSE

COST
♦ 1

DARK

SIGNATURE

RESPONSE

Dark: Stress Tests can charge for it on your board or in your discard pile; Signature: one copy per deck; Response: play while a Stress Test is being run.

Stop a Liquidity or Reputation Stress Test that hits you, unless the player who ran it pays 3 more Leverage.

The chairman was calm, confident, and on live television. Two of those were true.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 146 / 357

TALENT

Executive Assistant

FRONT LINE

HIRE
♦ 2

Commit: Uncommit a different non-funding card you control. Use this ability only once between the starts of your turns.

Found an opening in your calendar and put you in it.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 165 / 357

TALENT

Executive Assistant

FRONT LINE

HIRE
♦ 2

Commit: Uncommit a different non-funding card you control. Use this ability only once between the starts of your turns.

Found an opening in your calendar and put you in it.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 165 / 357

TALENT

Corporate Spy

FRONT LINE

DARK

HIRE

◆ 2

DARK

Dark: Stress Tests can charge for it on your board or in your discard pile.

Each opponent's maximum hand size is 1 lower.

Badge says Facilities, laptop says otherwise.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 207 / 357

TALENT

Risk Management Professor

ACADEMIC

HIRE

◆ 2

When you hire this employee, search your deck for a Program, show it, and put it in your hand. Then shuffle your deck.

Wrote the textbook your CRO still keeps on the desk.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 204 / 357

TOOL

Delegation Dashboard

SOFTWARE

PRICE

◆ 3

Cyber

Commit: Uncommit a different non-funding card you control. Use this ability only once between the starts of your turns.

That meeting could have been somebody else's meeting.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 343 / 357

SIGNATURE TOOL

Generative AI Pilot

SOFTWARE

PRICE

◆ 2

CARRYING COST

● 1 each turn

SIGNATURE

AI

Cyber

Signature: one copy per deck; AI: AI Bubble Bursts destroys it.

Your maximum hand size is 1 higher.

Summarizes every report in the building, including three that don't exist.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 352 / 357

SURPRISE INSPECTION

Whistleblower

CORPORATE

COST

◆ 2

HITS

Target opponent

Target opponent loses 6 Surplus per Dark card in their discard pile.

After losses, each company hit discards every investment named Shell Company, Feeder Fund, Affiliate Loan, or Guaranteed Returns Fund it controls.

She kept copies of everything, including the email telling her not to.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 291 / 357

SURPRISE INSPECTION

Reinsurer Insolvency

MARKET

COST

◆ 2

HITS

Target opponent

Target opponent has one Program to discard, chosen by the runner.

The treaty was airtight. The reinsurer was not.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 328 / 357

STRESS TEST

Liquidity Crunch

LIQUIDITY

HITS

Every company from the pile

Liquidity

Short-Term Equity

Credit

Volatility

Every company loses 3 Surplus per Liquidity exposure, 3 per Short-Term Equity exposure, 3 per Credit exposure, and 2 per Volatility exposure.

After losses, each company hit discards every investment named Private Credit Fund it controls.

Everyone wants cash, so nobody is bidding on your assets.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 262 / 357

SIGNATURE STRESS TEST

Flash Crash

MARKET - AS-IF REPLAY, 2010

HITS

Every company from the pile

SIGNATURE

ACT OF GOD

Short-Term Equity

Volatility

Signature: one copy per deck; Act of God: can't be stopped.

Every company loses 6 Surplus per Short-Term Equity exposure and 2 per Volatility exposure.

After losses, each company hit discards every investment named Meme Stock it controls.

On May 6, 2010, a burst of automated selling briefly wiped about a trillion dollars off the value of U.S. stocks. The Dow fell almost 1,000 points in minutes, then mostly came back.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 276 / 357

STRESS TEST

Social Inflation Surge

LITIGATION

HITS

Every company from the pile

Litigation

Every company loses 8 Surplus per Litigation exposure.

Billboard lawyers, litigation funding, and juries that have seen the headlines.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 275 / 357

Asbestos Claims

LITIGATION



HITS

Every company *from the pile*

SIGNATURE

ACT OF GOD

DEVELOPING EVENT

▲ Litigation

Signature: one copy per deck; Act of God: can't be stopped; Developing Event: stage 1 now, the next stage at the end of each later round.

Stage 1. Every company loses 4 Surplus per Litigation exposure.

Stage 2. Every company loses 4 Surplus per Litigation exposure.

Stage 3. Every company loses 4 Surplus per Litigation exposure.

The exposure was decades old, and the claims kept coming for decades more.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 285 / 357

1906 San Francisco Earthquake

NAT CAT · AS-IF REPLAY, 1906



HITS

Every company *from the pile*

SIGNATURE

ACT OF GOD

▲ Nat Cat: Earthquake

▲ Property Value

Signature: one copy per deck; Act of God: can't be stopped.

Every company loses 12 Surplus per Nat Cat: Earthquake exposure and 4 per Property Value exposure.

On April 18, 1906, a magnitude 7.9 earthquake struck San Francisco, and the fires that followed burned for three days and destroyed most of the city.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 244 / 357

Hurricane Harvey

NAT CAT · AS-IF REPLAY, 2017



HITS

Every company *from the pile*

SIGNATURE

ACT OF GOD

▲ Nat Cat: Flood

Signature: one copy per deck; Act of God: can't be stopped.

Every company loses 10 Surplus per Nat Cat: Flood exposure.

In August 2017, Hurricane Harvey stalled over southeast Texas for days and dropped up to 60 inches of rain, flooding much of Houston.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 230 / 357

1927 Mississippi River Flood

NAT CAT · AS-IF REPLAY, 1927



HITS

Every company *from the pile*

SIGNATURE

ACT OF GOD

▲ Nat Cat: Flood

Signature: one copy per deck; Act of God: can't be stopped.

Every company loses 10 Surplus per Nat Cat: Flood exposure.

In 1927 the Mississippi River broke through its levees in more than 100 places, flooding 27,000 square miles and displacing hundreds of thousands of people.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 245 / 357

Cancer Cured

LONGEVITY



HITS

Every company *from the pile*

SIGNATURE

▲ Longevity

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 12 Surplus per Longevity exposure.

Champagne in the lab, followed by a very quiet meeting in annuity reserving.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 239 / 357

Volcker Shock

RATES · AS-IF REPLAY, 1979



HITS

Every company *from the pile*

SIGNATURE

▲ Short-Term Rates

▲ Liquidity

▲ Volatility

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 6 Surplus per Short-Term Rates exposure, 2 per Liquidity exposure, and 2 per Volatility exposure.

In October 1979 the Federal Reserve let short-term rates climb toward 20% to break inflation, and the savings and loans that had funded 30-year mortgages with passbook savings never recovered.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 295 / 357

Opioid Epidemic

MORTALITY



HITS

Every company *from the pile*

SIGNATURE

▲ Mortality

▲ Litigation

▲ Health Price

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 4 Surplus per Mortality exposure, 4 per Litigation exposure, and 4 per Health Price exposure.

Overdose deaths rose for two decades, and the lawsuits followed.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 236 / 357